

Cognitive Behavioral Therapy Foundations

Learner guide | SWP-005 | School of Mental Health & Clinical Practice

This guide supports a three-part learning sequence for Cognitive Behavioral Therapy Foundations. By the end of the course, you should be able to explain core CBT concepts and use basic, supervised CBT-informed tools appropriately.

Practice notice: Apply the law, organisational policy, supervision requirements, and approved referral pathways that govern your setting. This material supports learning and does not replace urgent safeguarding, clinical, or legal procedures.

Learning objectives

- Explain core CBT concepts and use basic, supervised CBT-informed tools appropriately.
- Apply the key ideas from The CBT model.
- Apply the key ideas from Core tools.
- Apply the key ideas from Ethical application.

Course structure

Module	Focus	Suggested study time
1. The CBT model	links among situations, thoughts, emotions, bodily responses, and behaviour	10 to 15 minutes
2. Core tools	agenda setting, thought records, cognitive reappraisal, behavioural activation, and homework	10 to 15 minutes
3. Ethical application	collaboration, cultural adaptation, limits of competence, monitoring, and referral	10 to 15 minutes

Module 1 The CBT model

This module focuses on links among situations, thoughts, emotions, bodily responses, and behaviour. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Links among situations
- Thoughts
- Emotions
- Bodily responses
- Behaviour

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of the cbt model in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of links among situations, thoughts, emotions, bodily responses, and behaviour. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through the cbt model safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 2 Core tools

This module focuses on agenda setting, thought records, cognitive reappraisal, behavioural activation, and homework. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Agenda setting
- Thought records
- Cognitive reappraisal
- Behavioural activation
- Homework

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of core tools in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of agenda setting, thought records, cognitive reappraisal, behavioural activation, and homework. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through core tools safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 3 Ethical application

This module focuses on collaboration, cultural adaptation, limits of competence, monitoring, and referral. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Collaboration
- Cultural adaptation
- Limits of competence
- Monitoring
- Referral

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of ethical application in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of collaboration, cultural adaptation, limits of competence, monitoring, and referral. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through ethical application safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Course activity

Use the accompanying worksheet to apply the course sequence to a short case. Your completed activity should show what you noticed, the action you would take within your role, and what you would escalate or verify locally.

Assessment preparation

- Review the distinction between: cognitive triangle.
- Review the distinction between: tool selection.
- Review the distinction between: collaborative practice.
- Review the distinction between: scope limits.

References and local adaptation

- SWEEP Academy Course Content Outlines, production blueprint for this course.
- The current legislation, professional standards, safeguarding procedures, and referral directories for the delivery jurisdiction.
- The learner's employer or placement policy, supervision arrangements, and documentation standards.